

BRILLIANT

1. Passage anchor

> “First of all, she is academically **brilliant**.”

Passage meaning

brilliant = exceptionally intelligent, talented, or impressive

非常聰明的；才華出眾的；極為出色的

Here:

> **academically brilliant**

= **在學術 / 學業方面非常出色**

The speaker means Ms. Lau has exceptionally strong academic ability and subject mastery.

Practice

1. She is academically **brilliant**, but she never shows off.

她在學業上非常**出色**，但從不炫耀。

2. He is a **brilliant** student with a deep understanding of mathematics.

他是一名非常**聰明出色**的學生，對數學理解很深。

Core meanings of BRILLIANT

2. brilliant — extremely intelligent or talented

= exceptionally clever, intelligent, or talented

極聰明的；才華出眾的；非常有才華的

This is the exact passage branch.

Examples

1. She is a **brilliant scientist**.

她是一位非常**傑出**的科學家。

2. He was a **brilliant student**.

他是一名**極為聰明**的學生。

3. brilliant at something

= extremely skilled or talented at a particular activity

很擅長.....；在.....方面非常出色

Examples

1. She is **brilliant at explaining difficult ideas**.

她**非常擅長解釋困難概念**。

2. He is **brilliant at mathematics**.

他**數學非常出色**。

Extremely good / impressive

4. brilliant — excellent

= extremely good, successful, enjoyable, or impressive

極好的；出色的；精彩的

Examples

1. That was a **brilliant presentation**.

那是一場非常**精彩的簡報**。

2. We had a **brilliant time**.

我們度過了一段非常**愉快的時光**。

Very common, especially in British English.

5. brilliant idea

= extremely clever or effective idea

絕妙的主意；很棒的點子

Examples

1. That's a **brilliant idea**.

那是個**絕妙的主意**。

2. She came up with a **brilliant solution**.

她想出了一個**非常巧妙的解決方法**。

6. brilliant performance

= exceptionally impressive performance

精彩表現；出色演出

Examples

1. She gave a **brilliant performance**.

她有非常**精彩的表現**。

2. The team produced a **brilliant performance** under pressure.

團隊在壓力下交出了**出色表現**。

Bright / shining

7. brilliant — very bright or shining

= giving off or reflecting a lot of light

明亮的；燦爛的；耀眼的

Examples

1. The room was filled with **brilliant light**.

房間裡充滿了**耀眼的光**。

2. A **brilliant flash** lit up the sky.

一道**耀眼的閃光**照亮了天空。

This is a major literal sense.

8. brilliant sunshine

= very bright sunlight

燦爛陽光；強烈陽光

Examples

1. We walked outside in **brilliant sunshine**.

我們走到戶外，陽光非常**燦爛**。

2. The snow reflected the **brilliant sunlight**.

雪反射著**耀眼的陽光**。

Colour

9. brilliant — very vivid or intense in colour

= extremely bright and strong in colour

鮮豔的；亮麗的

Examples

1. The bird had **brilliant blue feathers**.

那隻鳥有**鮮豔的藍色羽毛**。

2. She wore a dress in **brilliant red**.

她穿了一件**鮮紅色**的裙子。

Gem / diamond

10. brilliant — sparkling strongly

= reflecting light intensely and attractively

閃耀的；璀璨的

Examples

1. The diamond looked **brilliant** under the lights.

鑽石在燈光下顯得非常**璀璨**。

2. The jewels gave off a **brilliant sparkle**.

珠寶散發出**耀眼光芒**。

Noun: brilliant

11. brilliant — a particular diamond cut

In gemology:

= a style of cutting a diamond or gemstone with many facets to maximize brilliance

****明亮式切割；圓形明亮式切割****

Examples

1. The ring contains a round ****brilliant**** diamond.

這枚戒指鑲有一顆圓形****明亮式切割鑽石****。

2. The stone was cut as a ****brilliant****.

這顆寶石採用****明亮式切割****。

Specialist sense.

Exclamation / conversational use

12. Brilliant!

Especially in British English:

= excellent! great! that's very good!

****太好了！很棒！****

Examples

1. "We finished early." *****Brilliant!*****

「我們提早完成了。」 ****太好了！****

2. "I found the missing file." *****Brilliant!*****

「我找到遺失的檔案了。」 ****太棒了！****

Very common conversational use.

Sarcastic use

13. brilliant — sarcastic

Can be used to mean the opposite:

= "great" said sarcastically when something has gone wrong

****真棒啊（反諷）；可真行****

Examples

1. “The printer is broken again.” “**Brilliant.**”
「印表機又壞了。」 「**真棒啊。**」
2. “We missed the last train.” “**Brilliant.**”
「我們錯過末班車了。」 「**真是太好了。**」

Tone completely changes the meaning.

Related forms

14. brilliantly

A. extremely skillfully or successfully

****出色地；精彩地****

1. She explained the idea ****brilliantly****.
她把這個概念解釋得非常****出色****。
2. The team performed ****brilliantly****.
團隊表現得非常****精彩****。

B. very brightly

****明亮地；耀眼地****

3. The stars shone ****brilliantly****.
星星****耀眼地****閃爍。

15. brilliance

A. exceptional intelligence or talent

****才華；卓越智慧****

1. Everyone admired her ****brilliance****.
大家都很佩服她的****才華****。
2. His mathematical ****brilliance**** was obvious.

他的數學**才華**非常明顯。

B. intense brightness

****光輝；耀眼程度****

3. The ****brilliance**** of the light was almost uncomfortable.

那道光的****耀眼程度****幾乎讓人不舒服。

C. vividness of colour

****鮮豔；亮麗****

4. The painting is known for the ****brilliance of its colours****.

這幅畫以色彩的****鮮豔亮麗****聞名。

High-value collocations

16. absolutely brilliant

= extremely good or impressive

****非常棒；極其出色****

Examples

1. Her explanation was ****absolutely brilliant****.

她的解釋****實在太精彩了****。

2. The idea is ****absolutely brilliant****.

這個想法****非常出色****。

17. brilliant mind

= exceptionally intelligent mind/person

****卓越頭腦；聰明絕頂的人****

Examples

1. She has a ****brilliant mind****.

她有一個****非常聰明的頭腦****。

2. The discovery came from a ****brilliant mind****.

這項發現出自一位**才智出眾的人**。

18. brilliant career

= highly successful or distinguished career

輝煌的職涯；傑出的事業

Examples

1. She had a **brilliant career** in science.
她在科學領域有一段**輝煌的職涯**。
2. He went on to have a **brilliant career** as a researcher.
他後來成為研究員，事業非常**出色**。

19. brilliant success

= outstanding success

巨大成功；輝煌成就

Examples

1. The experiment was a **brilliant success**.
這次實驗取得了**巨大成功**。
2. The event was a **brilliant success**.
這次活動取得了**非常出色的成果**。

Key contrasts

20. brilliant vs intelligent

****intelligent****

= having strong mental ability

聰明的

****brilliant****

= exceptionally intelligent or talented; stronger

極聰明的；才華出眾的

Compare:

> She is **intelligent**.

> 她很聰明。

> She is **brilliant**.

> 她聰明得非常出眾。

In the passage, **brilliant** raises the intensity.

21. brilliant vs clever

clever

= quick and effective at thinking or solving problems

聰明的 ; 機靈的

brilliant

= much stronger; exceptionally clever or impressive

Compare:

> a clever answer

> 聰明的回答

> a brilliant answer

> 極其出色的回答

22. brilliant vs smart

smart

= everyday word for intelligent, especially in American English

聰明的

brilliant

= stronger and often more enthusiastic

Compare:

> She's really smart.

> 她真的很聰明。

> She's absolutely brilliant.

> 她真的非常出色。

23. brilliant vs excellent

****excellent****

= extremely good in quality

****優秀的；極好的****

****brilliant****

can mean excellent but also:

* very intelligent

* very bright

* vivid in colour

Compare:

> an ****excellent teacher****

> 優秀老師

> a ****brilliant teacher****

> 非常出色、甚至才華非凡的老師

24. brilliant vs outstanding

****outstanding****

= exceptionally good compared with others

****傑出的****

****brilliant****

= can emphasize intelligence, creativity, vivid success, or excellence

Compare:

> an outstanding academic record

> 傑出的學業紀錄

> a brilliant explanation

> 極為精彩的解釋

25. brilliant vs bright

Both can refer to light and intelligence.

Light

- * bright light
- * brilliant light

brilliant usually suggests greater intensity or sparkle.

Intelligence

bright

= intelligent and quick to learn

聰明的

brilliant

= exceptionally intelligent

才華極其出眾的

26. brilliant vs dazzling

dazzling

= so bright or impressive that it overwhelms

耀眼的；令人目眩的

brilliant

= very bright, but does not necessarily imply discomfort or overwhelm.

Compare:

> brilliant sunshine

> 燦爛陽光

> dazzling headlights

> 刺眼車燈

Meaning map

The central historical concept of **brilliant** is:

****shining very brightly****

From this develops a metaphor:

****something shines****

→ ****something stands out exceptionally****

So the major branches are:

Light

brilliant light

→ ****耀眼的光****

Colour

brilliant red

→ ****鮮豔紅色****

Intelligence

brilliant student

→ ****才智出眾的學生****

Quality

brilliant idea

→ ****絕妙主意****

Performance

brilliant performance

→ ****精彩表現****

Conversation

Brilliant!

→ ****太棒了！****

The passage uses the intelligence/excellence branch:

****academically brilliant****

→ ****在學術方面才智極為出眾****

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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brilliant — intelligence/talent	智力或才能遠高於一般水平；極聰明的 / 才華出眾的
brilliant at something	在某項活動、技能或學科上表現極為出色
brilliant — excellent	品質、結果、體驗或表現極好；精彩的 / 出色的
brilliant idea/solution	非常聰明、巧妙或有效的主意 / 解決方案
brilliant performance	極為精彩、令人印象深刻的表現
brilliant — light	發出或反射非常強烈的光；明亮的 / 耀眼的
brilliant sunshine/light	非常明亮、強烈或燦爛的陽光 / 光線
brilliant — colour	色彩非常鮮明、強烈；鮮豔的
brilliant — gemstone	反射出強烈光芒、顯得璀璨的
Brilliant!	非正式表示「非常好、太棒了」
brilliant — sarcastic	用反諷語氣表示事情其實很糟；「真棒啊」
brilliantly — skillfully	以非常出色、精彩的方式
brilliantly — brightly	以非常明亮、耀眼的方式
brilliance — intelligence/talent	非凡的才智、卓越才能
brilliance — brightness	強烈的光輝 / 耀眼程度
brilliance — colour	色彩的鮮豔與亮麗
brilliant mind	極其聰明、有非凡思考能力的頭腦 / 人物
brilliant career	成就非常突出的輝煌職涯

Passage recap

> “First of all, she is academically **brilliant**.”

Here:

brilliant = **exceptionally intelligent and academically capable**

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **極為聰明的**

* **才華出眾的**

* **非常出色的**

Natural contextual translation:

首先，她在學術上真的非常出色。

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

brilliant

= ****exceptionally intelligent, talented, or impressive****

****極聰明的；才華出眾的；極為出色的****

In this passage:

> ****academically brilliant****

is stronger than simply:

> ****academically good****

It suggests that Ms. Lau's academic ability is ****exceptional****, not merely above average.

The important polysemy contrast is:

> ****brilliant teacher/student****

> → 才智出眾 / 非常出色

> ****brilliant light****

> → 耀眼的光

> ****brilliant colour****

> → 鮮豔的顏色

> ****Brilliant!****

> → 太棒了！